



Windows 11 in 2026

Stop using Windows 11 like it's Windows 7

Most Windows 11 users in India treat the OS the way they treat the air-conditioner remote: power button, temperature up/down, and absolutely no curiosity about the other 37 buttons. That's fine – until something breaks, the laptop slows to a crawl, or you realise the machine you paid ₹55,000 for is spending its best years running OEM “optimisation” apps that optimise exactly nothing.

This chapter is your “get real” baseline. Before we talk about virtual desktops, WSL, privacy hardening, or recovery magic, you need to know three things:

1. What Windows 11 you're actually running (edition + version + build).
2. Whether your security foundations are real (TPM + Secure Boot + UEFI).
3. Whether your laptop is quietly sabotaging you (bloatware, junk startup apps, and questionable vendor utilities).

Do these right and every chapter after this becomes easier, faster, and less scary.

1) Identify your Windows 11

Windows 11 updates are not just “updates”. They're a moving platform. Features arrive in waves; fixes are tied to builds. If you're troubleshooting, installing tools, or following any guide on Earth, edition/version/build is your identity card.

Microsoft's simplest method: Settings → System → About.

Step-by-step: Check your Windows 11 edition & build

1. Right-click Start → Settings